November 2014. The House approved another revised version on May 13, 2015, and it passed in the Senate on June 2, 2015. After the Senate vote, President Obama said in a statement, "Enactment of this legislation will strengthen civil liberty safeguards and provide greater public confidence in these [surveillance] programs."[7] He signed the bill into law later that day. Among other provisions, the act ended mass collection of US phone records by the NSA. Critics of the bill said it would weaken the United States' ability to protect itself.

Court Decisions

In an encouraging win for privacy advocates, on December 16, 2013, US District Judge Richard J. Leon issued an opinion that the NSA's collection of US domestic phone records was probably unconstitutional and violated the Fourth Amendment. In

ALTERNATIVE TO MASS SURVEILLANCE

Even Snowden has said some surveillance is necessary for national security. What he and others concerned with NSA overreach propose is a return to targeted, rather than mass, surveillance. As members of Obama's panel and Judge Leon pointed out, history shows no act of terrorism was ever stopped as a result of mass surveillance. In almost every case where a terrorist act was uncovered and the perpetrators successfully prosecuted, it was as a result of targeted surveillance and investigators interviewing people and following specific leads.

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